

GREAT IDEAS

GREAT MINDS

Rohini Pande

A temporary policy of **GENDER QUOTAS** is necessary. Only then will Indian women emerge as a strong political force.

Pradhan Das said, "In the future, the plan of the Panchayat will be 'plans with equal sharings' (Samobhagi Parikalpana). The Government will provide some amount of the money and the rest will be borne by the people either by giving labour or by helping financially."

Do you think Pradhan Das is an effective leader? What if I told you her first name is Sandhya?

Most of us would deny that changing the gender of the speaker would affect our evaluation of his/her performance. Yet studies in

rural West Bengal, in which the gender of the speaker was randomly varied, found significant bias against female leaders. Today women make up half of the world's voters but only 18 per cent of its parliamentarians. For India, this figure stands at 9.1 per cent for national legislators, and the number of female legislators in most Indian states hovers around 10 per cent.

Why are women so under-represented at high levels of administration and in leadership positions?

According to the recent World Values Survey, more than half of the Indian respondents believe men make better leaders than

On track: No job is too tough or too complicated for the Indian woman

SHRIYA PATIL SHINDE

